

displays that closely resembles an Android smartphone. While the Android vs. iOS operating system battle might not present a clear winner, Android Auto is simply much superior to Apple CarPlay, in almost every aspect.

As against Apple's measly third party app support for CarPlay in India, Android Auto brings support for over 50 third party apps, including the essential communication apps like WhatsApp, Facebook and even Google Hangouts. There are other music applications that are supported (like Play Music, JetAudio, etc.), and all of this makes Android Auto much more practical and useful on Indian roads. If that still does not convince you, Android Auto get Google Maps, which outperforms any in-car navigation



This is what CarPlay's nemesis looks like

system, no matter how sophisticated it may be. This is because Google Maps brings with it familiarity, ease of use, live traffic updates, essential nearby landmarks and more. Adding to that is the Google Assistant's voice-based interface, which is more adept at picking up the Indian accent.

Android Auto presents every new notification here in a card format. If you receive a WhatsApp message, the notification will show up on the car display (CarPlay does not even show third party notifications), and tapping on the card will result in Google Assistant reading out the message. Here again, visual presentation of data is avoided to minimise driver distractions.

Connecting Android Auto to a car system needs downloading of the Android Auto application on phone, but that is little price that you pay for